

Grid Wire — 2026-06-17

Energy / power / capital-markets intelligence. Bias toward the non-obvious: transcript Q&A color, deal terms and comps, regulatory footnotes, and secondary disclosures — not the headline prints. Window ~early-May to mid-June 2026 unless noted. Sources inline.

Through-lines

1. **Power is the binding constraint, not chips or capital.** Microsoft says GPUs are sitting in inventory for lack of energization; turbine slots, not money, gate new gas. 2. **OBBBA/FEOC is bifurcating clean energy** — storage, 45Q CCS, and geothermal attract capital and premiums; resi-solar dealers, offshore wind, and green hydrogen retreat. A June 6 court vacatur restored the 5% safe harbor, making 2026 construction starts the decisive race against the July 4, 2026 cliff. 3. **Brownfield power trades at a deep discount to greenfield** — PJM gas changing hands at \$743–1,327/kW vs >\$2,000/kW new-build, while data-center demand bids up the curve. 4. **The Meta/Blue Owl \$29.5B Hyperion SPV is the template** the rest of the hyperscaler field is now expected to copy.

Oil & Gas — Permian operations color

- **Permian Resources shutting in high-GOR gas wells in the –\$5 to –\$10 Waha range** — Walter framed them as "gas wells with extremely high GORs that don't make sense to produce in a negative gas environment," restart slated 2H26. Realized gas just **\$1.33/Mcf** in Q1. D&C cost hit **\$685/lateral ft** (closing on a \$675 target; ~10%/yr reductions since 2022), fastest well ever at >2,500 ft/day, ~70% recycled water. Firm transport only **400 MMcf/d now → >700 MMcf/d in 2027+**.

— Motley Fool, 2026-06-01, fool.com/earnings/call-transcripts/2026/06/01/permian-resources-pr-q1-2026-earnings-transcript/

- **Diamondback drove drilling to \$300/ft** (from \$360 in 2025) on 2–4-mile laterals, sub-\$400/ft in the Barnett; kept 5 frac crews year-round including a Halliburton e-fleet simul-frac crew it had planned to release. Q1 laterals averaged 11.5 miles, guiding 12.9 FY26. Surfactant trials averaged ~100 bbl/d uplift but "some wells were up 400 or 500 barrels a day and some were 0." Moving Waha exposure from financial to physical hedges as new pipes start; "on the cusp" of monetizing gas into a power/data-center project worked ~a year.

— Insider Monkey, 2026-05-05,

insidermonkey.com/blog/diamondback-energy-inc-nasdaqfang-q1-2026-earnings-call-transcript-1754766/

- **APA voluntarily curtailed ~88 MMcf/d gas + 6,800 bbl/d NGLs** in Q1 on negative Waha; realized US gas of **–\$0.35/Mcf**. The NGL cut was a knock-on — wet-gas wells taken down together.

— NGI / StockTitan (APA 8-K), 2026-04,

stocktitan.net/news/APA/apa-corporation-provides-first-quarter-2026-supplemental-information-cixo5u8gag25.html

- **EOG pulling capital out of Dorado dry gas** (~1 Bcf/d → ~800 MMcf/d), redeploying to oil (+5 net Delaware, +10 net Utica completions); budget flat at \$6.5B but oil +2 Mb/d. Janus Delaware plant hit full utilization in March, cutting GP&T. Utica drilled-feet/day +22% vs 2025.

— Motley Fool, 2026-05-06, fool.com/earnings/call-transcripts/2026/05/06/eog-eog-q1-2026-earnings-call-transcript/

Waha basis / egress

- **89 consecutive negative Waha sessions since Feb 4** — shattering the prior record of 27 (2024). Balance-of-summer strip ripped ~\$0.70 higher to **–\$3.11/MMBtu** by June 11, but the forward curve prices negative Waha into 2028: **Summer-2027 strip –\$1.98, Winter '27-'28 –\$2.11**. Relief, not resolution.

— NGI, June 2026, naturalgasintel.com/news/permian-natural-gas-prices-sink-deeper-into-negative-territory-amid-pipeline-constraints/; Aegis Hedging, mid-May 2026, aegis-hedging.com/insights/waha-prices-at-multi-year-low-foretells-future-risk

- **Egress relief timeline:** GCX expansion +0.6 Bcf/d in Q2; Blackcomb + Hugh Brinson Phase 1 add ~4.0 Bcf/d combined in 2H26; Hugh Brinson Phase 2 +0.7 early 2027. Hugh Brinson is \$2.7B / 2.2 Bcf/d, 100% of pipe

delivered and mainline ~75% built by Feb. Blackcomb (2.5 Bcf/d, Q3) is WhiteWater 50.6% / MPLX 30.4% / Enbridge 19%.

— *Oil & Gas Journal*, 2026,

ogj.com/pipelines-transportation/pipelines/article/55378380/perman-gas-pipeline-debottlenecking-advancing-at-full-speed

Midstream & upstream M&A — comps

- **Western Midstream / Brazos: \$1.6B (~\$800M cash / \$800M units) at ~8x 2027E EBITDA** (~7.5x with synergies). Adds 470k+ dedicated acres, 900+ mi pipe, ~460 MMcf/d processing (incl. ~125 MMcf/d unused at Comanche); 9.2-yr WALC, ~\$100M incremental 2026 EBITDA, ~3x pro forma leverage. Management called it "more of an asset deal" — only ~60–70 field staff. 3,500 locations economic at \$65 oil.

— *Yahoo Finance (WES Q1 call)*, 2026-05, finance.yahoo.com/markets/stocks/articles/wes-q1-2026-earnings-call-202142070.html

- **Viper Energy (Diamondback) / Sitio Royalties: \$4.1B all-stock** (incl. ~\$1.1B assumed debt), +~25,300 net royalty acres in the Permian — minerals consolidation, announced June 3.

— *JPT/SPE*, 2026-06, jpt.spe.org/diamondbacks-viper-energy-boosts-permian-position-with-4-1-billion-acquisition

- **SM Energy (Caturus) Galvan Ranch: \$950M for ~60,000 net acres + 260 producing wells** (Webb County, Feb 2026).

— *Mercer Capital*, 2026, mercercapital.com/large-acquisitions-dominate-the-permian-ma-landscape/

- **Devon / Coterra** combination reported (May 2026); Coterra no longer trading independently — "merger-of-equals" consolidation among SMID shale names.

— *NGI*, 2026, naturalgasintel.com/news/apa-curtails-permian-natural-gas-output-citing-negative-waha-prices/

- **Q1 2026 upstream deal value ~\$38B (Enverus)** — most in two years — yet Rystad/Wood Mac expect 2026 to cool below 2025 despite ~\$152B of opportunities on the market; Ovintiv sold Anadarko assets for \$3B cash.

— *Argus/CryptoRank*, 2026, cryptorank.io/news/feed/4706a-upstream-oil-gas-ma-likely-to-cool-in-2026-despite-152b-in-opportunities

LNG — FIDs & offtake terms

- **Delfin FLNG 1 took FID June 3** — first US floating liquefaction unit, 4.4 mtpa, ~40 nm off Louisiana; third US project to FID in 2026. Structured on **Henry Hub-indexed SPAs** (Expand Energy ~1.15 mtpa 20-yr start 2031; Chesapeake ~0.5 mtpa 20-yr target 2028) rather than fixed-fee tolling — shifting commodity risk onto liquefiers/buyers as HH rises and US LNG margins tighten.

— *Offshore Energy / RBN*, June 2026,

offshore-energy.biz/gulf-coast-lng-projects-train-5-closer-to-fid-as-conocophillips-signs-up-for-20-year-offtake/; *Argus*, 2026, argusmedia.com/en/news-and-insights/latest-market-news/2762492-us-lng-margins-tighten-on-higher-henry-hub-prices

Data Centers & AI Infrastructure

- **Microsoft is power-bound, not chip-bound.** CFO Amy Hood: compute hardware "has not been a constraint" — space and power are. Nadella confirmed GPUs "sitting in inventory" for lack of power to energize them; cited an ~\$80B Azure backlog it cannot fulfill. Q-capex \$30.88B (+84% YoY).

— *DataCenterDynamics*, Apr 2026,

datacenterdynamics.com/en/news/microsoft-has-ai-gpus-sitting-in-inventory-because-it-lacks-the-power-necessary-to-install-them/

- **Meta raised 2026 capex to \$125–145B (~2x 2025's \$72B)**; Amazon Q-capex \$44.2B. 2026 hyperscaler aggregate tracking ~\$690–700B.

— *RBN Energy*, Apr 2026,

rbnenergy.com/daily-posts/analyst-insight/q1-2026-earnings-calls-meta-ramps-spending-fuel-massive-data-center

- **Behind-the-meter goes non-gas:** Bloom Energy–Oracle master agreement for up to **2.8 GW of on-site solid-oxide fuel cells (1.2 GW already underway)** — sidestepping both turbine queues and grid interconnection.

Brookfield committed up to \$5B to finance Bloom SOFC fleets, making on-site fuel cells a financeable asset class.

— Bloom IR, Apr 2026, investor.bloomenergy.com/press-releases/press-release-details/2026/Bloom-Energy-and-Oracle-Expand-Strategic-Partnership-to-Deploy-up-to-2-8-GW-to-Accelerate-AI-Infrastructure-Build-Out/default.aspx; DCD, 2026, datacenterdynamics.com/en/news/bloom-energy-signs-5bn-partnership-with-brookfield-to-deploy-fuel-cell-tech-across-ai-data-centers/

- **SMRs are not relieving 2026–2029 scarcity:** Oklo's ~15 GW book (Meta + Switch) and the Kairos–Google–TVA 50 MW PPA don't deliver until ~2030.

— Wikipedia (Oklo/Kairos), 2026, en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Oklo_Inc.

Stargate Abilene (Texas)

- **Oracle/OpenAI scrapped the planned 600 MW Abilene expansion**, redirecting capacity while the ~4.5 GW agreement stays on track; **Meta is in talks (with Nvidia's help) to absorb the Crusoe-built capacity**. Abilene runs ~0.6 GW now → ~1.2 GW by mid-2026 across 8 buildings, on-site gas + grid (incl. local wind). Signal: even flagship Stargate capacity is being reshuffled between hyperscalers.

— Tom's Hardware / DCD, 2026, tomshardware.com/tech-industry/oracle-and-openai-scrap-planned-600mw-abilene-expansion

Gas Turbine Bottleneck (cross-cutting)

- **GE Vernova: 100 GW under contract** (from 83 GW QoQ), targeting 110+ by YE26 — but **only ~10 GW of capacity remains across 2029–2030 combined**; customers spilled from sold-out 2029 into 2030 during Q1. **New-bid pricing ran 10–20 pts higher \$/kW than Q4 2025** and held through April. 231 HA units on order, 100+ uncommissioned. Q1 data-center electrification orders (\$2.4B) exceeded all of FY2025. Lead time "directionally 3 years."

— Investing.com (GEV Q1 transcript), 2026-04-22, investing.com/news/transcripts/earnings-call-transcript-ge-vernova-q1-2026-surpasses-expectations-93CH-4629287; Utility Dive, 2026-04-23, utilitydive.com/news/ge-vernova-gas-turbine-backlog-hits-100-gw-as-prices-rise/818332/

- **Siemens Energy gas turbines sold out through FY2028; FY2029 filling fast**, likely sold out by YE26. Gas Services booked €8.9B (+32% YoY, record), backlog €154B, US demand "largely driven by data center expansion." Sector \$/kW projected toward ~\$600/kW by end-2027, ~3x 2019.

— DailyPolitical / Siemens Energy Q2 FY26, 2026, dailypolitical.com/2026/03/30/siemens-energy-q2-pre-close-call-guidance-reaffirmed-middle-east-risks-watched-gas-turbines-sold-out-to-2028.html

Nuclear & Power Generation

SMR / advanced reactors — milestones and slippage

- **Oklo** cleared Aurora powerhouse PDSA June 11 (after the A3F fuel-facility PDSA in Dec, first under DOE's Fuel Line Pilot); commercial Aurora at INL still "late 2027/early 2028." The fuel facility will fabricate initial cores from recycled EBR-II fuel — a supply path competitors lack.

— NucNet, 2026-06, nucnet.org/news/doe-approves-key-safety-analysis-for-oklo-aurora-nuclear-plant-in-idaho-6-5-2026

- **TerraPower Natrium (Kemmerer) got its NRC construction permit March 4** — first for an advanced commercial reactor in 40+ years; legal de-risk, but the sodium/molten-salt energy-island schedule is still the gating item.

— Wikipedia/TerraPower, 2026, en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kemmerer_Power_Station

- **X-energy** reported Q1 (June 4) as newly public (NASDAQ: XE); its own filings flag prior and prospective "delays, cost overruns or other complications" on Xe-100 and TRISO-X as live risk.

— SEC EDGAR 10-Q, 2026, sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/0002088896/000119312526256376/xe-20260331.htm

Restarts — documentation is the binding constraint

- **Palisades slipped again:** at the Feb 9 NRC meeting Holtec admitted it "cannot find the CMTR data" (certified material test reports) for post-weld heat treatment on three welds; NRC also demanded repair drawings. Paperwork, not hardware, is gating restart.

— *Industrial Info*, Feb 2026,

industrialinfo.com/news/article/restart-of-michigans-palisades-nuclear-plant-faces-another-potential-delay--353365

- **Crane/TMI-1** comes back online before earning full PJM capacity credit (not until 2027); Constellation was "hoping for a FERC response in the June–July timeframe" on the Capacity Interconnection Rights transfer. **Duane Arnold** (NextEra–Google) is the least-derisked — licensing-change request filed, no public cost/date.

— *Investing.com* (Constellation Q1), 2026-05,

investing.com/news/transcripts/earnings-call-transcript-constellation-energy-q1-2026-beats-forecasts-93CH-4677180

IPP earnings color — direct ERCOT signal

- **Constellation calls ERCOT "undervalued," specifically 2028–2029:** the forward curve "appears like something that's only expecting 10,000–15,000 MW" of load growth vs. their materially higher view, while they stay "well hedged" against near-term ERCOT weakness. Byron/Braidwood uprates "in plan," capital spent, but no EPS accretion until 2030. Now monetizing the **Calpine gas fleet** for data centers (CyrusOne supply deal), not just nuclear.

— *Investing.com* / *TIKR* (Constellation Q1), 2026-05,

tikr.com/blog/constellation-energy-q1-2026-earnings-revenue-doubles-on-calpine-eps-guidance-affirmed

- **Talen capital rule:** new generation only with "a direct offtake agreement with a hyperscaler or through an RBP award" — explicitly excludes repowering. Prefers batteries/CTs over CCGTs on cost; characterized the merchant-vs-contract spread as "not a couple of bucks... a pretty large spread." **AWS Susquehanna restructured to front-of-meter retail: up to 1,920 MW through 2042, ~\$18B / 17-yr** (the workaround after FERC rejected the 480 MW behind-the-meter co-location). Disclosed up to 3,000 acres for 3–4 GW of data-center capacity; price/MW withheld.

— *Investing.com* (Talen Q1), 2026-05,

investing.com/news/transcripts/earnings-call-transcript-talen-energys-q1-2026-results-show-robust-growth-93CH-4661290;

enki.ai.com/nuclear/aws-data-center-talen-energy/

Utilities & Power M&A — comps

- **NextEra / Dominion: \$67B all-stock** — fixed 0.8138 NEE per DOM + one-time \$360M cash; pro forma 74.5% NEE / 25.5% DOM, close mid-to-late 2027. Largest regulated electric utility; explicit AI-load play.

— *Motley Fool*, 2026-05, fool.com/investing/2026/05/19/nextera-energys-67-billion-dominion-energy-acquisi/

- **Talen / Energy Capital Partners closed: 2.6 GW PJM gas for \$3.45B** (\$2.55B cash + ~\$900M / 2.4M shares) — **~6.6x 2027E EBITDA, ~\$1,327/kW, >15% annual FCF/share accretion through 2030E.**

— *Talen IR*, 2026, ir.talenenergy.com/news-releases/news-release-details/talen-energy-continues-portfolio-expansion-acquisition

- **Brownfield-vs-greenfield comp:** **Vistra/Lotus ~\$743/kW for PJM gas vs >\$2,000/kW greenfield.** NRG/LS Power \$12B is the most transformational IPP roll-up; merchant capacity revenues locked through 2028.

— *NGI*, 2026, naturalgasintel.com/news/vistra-betting-on-us-natural-gas-fueled-future-with-19b-lotus-deal/

- **Coal life-extensions on reliability grounds** continue (e.g., OPD North Omaha extended "indefinitely") — the pattern is the signal, not any single plant.

— *Wikipedia*, 2026, en.wikipedia.org/wiki/North_Omaha_Power_Plant

Renewables & Clean Tech

Tax-equity / transferability — pricing plumbing

- **Transfer market grew ~50% YoY to ~\$42B in 2025** even as per-credit pricing softened (volume outran buyer depth; only ~27% of Fortune 1,000 bought credits). Pricing dipped to high-\$0.80s late 2025, recovered toward \$0.90+; Sunrun's CFO flagged H2 2026 could reprice "as high as the first half of last year." **Sunrun's rule of thumb: ~\$25M per penny** of transfer-price move — clean sensitivity for modeling resi-ITC risk.

— *Insider Monkey* (Sunrun Q1), 2026, insidermonkey.com/blog/sunrun-inc-nasdaqrun-q1-2026-earnings-call-transcript-1756020/; *Crux*, 2026, cruxclimate.com/insights/transferable-tax-credits

Resi solar — structural split

- Section 25D consumer ITC sunset end-2025: "many smaller dealers suffered significant volume declines" while Sunrun's lease/PPA (third-party-owned) model keeps the ITC and is harvesting talent from collapsing dealers (direct salesforce +20% YoY). Spending **\$50–100M cash this year purely on safe-harbor equipment** to extend ITC through 2030; storage attach hit 73% in Q1. Cautionary comp: Sunnova Ch. 11 (June 2025).

— *Insider Monkey*, 2026, insidermonkey.com/blog/sunrun-inc-nasdaqrun-q1-2026-earnings-call-transcript-1756020/

Offshore wind — writedowns and stop-work litigation

- **Equinor took a \$955M US offshore-wind impairment** (~\$763M on Empire Wind 1 + South Brooklyn Marine Terminal), attributed to regulatory change and tariffs. Both Ørsted (Revolution Wind) and Equinor (Empire Wind) sued BOEM and sought injunctions against stop-work orders in Jan 2026 — legal-cost overhang now a line item separate from delay.

— *Barchart*, 2026, barchart.com/story/news/33648047/eqnr-s-us-wind-projects-incur-955m-impairment-over-regulatory-changes

ERCOT storage — values up while wind/solar deals stall

- The divergence is the story: ERCOT 10-yr forward arbitrage value rose ~19% at peak in Q3 2025, but only **3 ERCOT PPAs announced vs 6 a year earlier** (wind offers +12%, solar +13%) on OBBBA "policy-driven shocks." **Battery storage M&A count surged >60% YoY**; solar-plus-storage commands premiums, and interconnection-queue position is "the primary currency." Non-FEOC "clean" supply chains trade at a scarcity premium. ERCOT toll comps landing: GridStor's 150 MW/300 MWh Gunnar (Hidalgo Co.) signed a Fortune 500 toll, COD end-2026; CPS Energy added two Eolian tolls.

— *Pexapark*, 2026, pexapark.com/blog/battery-storage-values-reach-record-highs-in-ercot-defying-policy-impacts-on-wind-and-solar-deals-pexapark/; *FTI Consulting*, 2026, fticonsulting.com/insights/articles/power-renewables-energy-transition-2025-ma-year-review-2026-outlook

Clean tech — hydrogen down, 45Q/CCS and geothermal up

- **OBBBA kills the 45V clean-hydrogen PTC** (start pulled to end-2027), pushing H2 from green to **blue specifically because 45Q survived** (\$85/ton industrial, \$180/ton DAC). CF Industries cited ~\$100M/yr incremental FCF from its Donaldsonville CCS 45Q stream.

— *ING Think*, 2026, think.ing.com/articles/energy-hydrogen-stuck-in-the-pilot-phase/; IRS Notice 2026-01 safe harbor, irs.gov/newsroom/treasury-irs-provide-safe-harbor-for-taxpayers-claiming-the-carbon-capture-credit

- **Geothermal financing maturing**: Fervo's Cape Station closed **\$421M non-recourse** March 19 (\$309M construction-to-term + \$61M tax-credit bridge monetizing the 30% ITC + \$51M LC), backed by a 3 GW Google framework and \$7.2B contracted PPA backlog. Offtake benchmark \$70–140/MWh; sub-\$70 LCOE the bankability threshold.

— *POWER Magazine*, 2026, powermag.com/fervo-energy-secures-more-funding-for-cape-station-geothermal-project/

- **Long-duration storage cooling**: Form Energy's last disclosed raise remains the \$450M Series E — no fresh 2026 round surfaced, a signal LDES funding lags geothermal.

— *Wikipedia* (Form Energy), 2026, en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Form_Energy

US Policy / Regulatory / Tax

Tax — OBBBA follow-on

- **Court vacated IRS Notice 2025-42 on June 6, restoring the 5% safe harbor** for wind/ solar >1.5 MW to establish beginning-of-construction (full vacatur; government likely to appeal/seek stay). Makes 2026 starts far easier against the **hard cliff: begin construction by July 4, 2026 OR placed-in-service by Dec 31, 2027** — and queue/permitting delays do not toll the placed-in-service backstop.

— McGuireWoods, June 2026, mcguirewoods.com/client-resources/alerts/2026/6/federal-court-vacates-irs-notice-2025-42-restores-5-safe-harbor-for-wind-and-solar-projects/

- **FEOC material-assistance rule (Notice 2026-15) has split effective dates** — material assistance applies to construction starting on/after Jan 1, 2026, but the IP/"effective control" rule is **retroactive to July 4, 2025**, putting 2025 licensing spend at risk. MACR ramp: qualified facilities 40% (2026) → 45% → 60%; storage 55% → 60% → 75%. **Iron and steel excluded from the calc** — a carve-out favoring steel-heavy domestic projects. **Geothermal has no Identification Safe Harbor** (a loser). Treasury must publish PFE-specific safe-harbor tables by Dec 31, 2026.

— Nixon Peabody, 2026-03-20, nixonpeabody.com/insights/alerts/2026/03/20/foreign-entities-of-concern-the-material-assistance-rule-and-irs-notice-2026-15

- **O&G structural tailwind:** OBBBA made 100% bonus depreciation permanent for property placed in service after Jan 19, 2026, so tangible drilling costs expense in year one alongside the 100% IDC deduction; with the §469(c)(3) working-interest exemption, drilling losses offset wages and capital gains. (California has not conformed.)

— BastaCPA, 2026, bastacpa.com/oil-gas-tax-breaks-explained-by-cpa/

FERC / DOE — large load & co-location

- **FERC found PJM's tariff "unjust and unreasonable" and ordered three new co-located-load service tiers** (193 FERC ¶ 61,217; compliance filings due Feb 16). The non-obvious bite: a new **behind-the-meter "materiality threshold"** capping netting benefits — FERC found BTM netting "can result in improper cost shifting" — eroding the economics of parking a data center behind a generator to dodge transmission charges (3-yr transition, grandfathering).

— Mintz, 2026-02-02, mintz.com/insights-center/viewpoints/2151/2026-02-02-ferc-directs-pjm-issue-new-rules-co-location-power

- **FERC generic large-load rulemaking (RM26-4)** on a deadline to act by June 2026 (loads >20 MW); SPP's "HILL" framework approved Jan 2026. **DOE's LPO now runs as the Office of Energy Dominance Financing** — 46 active loans + 25 conditional commitments, ~\$118B.

— FERC, ferc.gov/rm26-4; DOE, energy.gov/EDF

Permitting & tariffs

- **CEQ eliminated its NEPA regulations; DOE moved NEPA procedures out of the CFR.** Most consequential for grid: **DOE rescinded NEPA/APA review for Presidential Permits** (the authorization for cross-border transmission lines).

— Federal Register, 2026-02-24, federalregister.gov/documents/2026/02/24/2026-03708/national-environmental-policy-act-implementing-regulations

- **Section 232 metals tariffs restructured June 8:** 50% aluminum/steel/copper, 25% derivatives — but **grid equipment (transformers, switchgear) locked at 15% through Dec 31, 2027**. Two mechanics worth knowing: goods made abroad entirely from US-origin metal pay 10%; a **15%-or-less metal-content de minimis** exempts a product entirely.

— Green Worldwide, 2026, greenworldwide.com/section-232-tariff-reductions-for-agricultural-hvac-and-mobile-industrial-equipment-effective-june-8-2026/

Geopolitics

- **Strait of Hormuz reopened mid-June under a US-Iran 60-day ceasefire — but functionally closed.** US says mine-clearing takes ~6 months and insurers won't cover transits while mines remain; traffic hasn't resumed. War-risk premiums went from ~0.125% of hull pre-crisis to a March peak of 2.5–5% (~\$5M per VLCC transit).

— *Al Jazeera*, 2026-06-17, aljazeera.com/features/2026/6/17/strait-of-hormuz-reopens-how-will-safe-passage-for-ships-be-ensured

- **OPEC+ approved a fourth quota hike since the Hormuz closure on June 7 (+188 kb/d July)** — unwinding cuts into a disruption, not a glut: a market-share defense, the first adjustment since the UAE's exit removed an enforcement counterweight. Compliance is the soft underbelly — Kazakhstan hitting record output while nominally compensating.

— *The National*, 2026, thenationalnews.com/news/gulf/2026/05/03/opec-producers-agree-on-june-output-adjustment-and-reaffirm-market-stability-commitment/

- **Russia:** OFAC extended the Lukoil International divestiture license to June 27 (sale talks allowed, fund transfers to Russia barred; closing needs separate sign-off). Enforcement workaround intel: India↔China mid-voyage diversions and ship-to-ship transfers off Mumbai; UK clarified June 11 that insuring vessels calling at Transneft ports is unlikely to trip sanctions.

— *Crowell & Moring*, 2026, crowell.com/en/insights/client-alerts/key-takeaways-from-a-consequential-month-of-russia-related-sanctions

- **China critical minerals:** the October 2025 export-control expansion (5 added rare earths + extraterritorial reach) is **suspended only until Nov 10, 2026 — a cliff, not a resolution.** The Apr-2025 Dy/Tb/Gd licensing and the gallium/germanium/antimony/graphite framework remain operative. Watch the Nov expiry as a hard catalyst for grid-magnet and power-electronics (GaN, Ge) supply.

— *Pillsbury*, 2026, pillsburylaw.com/en/news-and-insights/china-suspends-export-controls-certain-critical-minerals-related-items.html

Capital Markets — debt, equity, infra funds

AI / data-center debt (dominant flow)

- **Nvidia priced \$25B IG bonds June 15** (first since 2021), order book ~\$85B (~3.4x covered), including a 30-yr tranche to 2056. AI-related borrowers have sold ~\$300B of bonds YTD 2026.

— *TechTimes*, 2026-06-16, techtimes.com/articles/318462/20260616/nvidia-raises-25-billion-bonds-its-largest-debt-deal-betting-decades-ai-growth.htm

- **Meta/Blue Owl Hyperion (Richland Parish, LA): \$27B debt + \$2.5B equity = \$29.5B.** Off-balance-sheet SPV, Blue Owl funds 80% / Meta 20%; debt rated A+ at +225 bp over Treasuries (~2x Meta's own corporate spread), anchored PIMCO ~\$18B, BlackRock ~\$3B. The A+ hinged on a 16-yr Meta residual-value guarantee absorbing tech-obsolescence risk; equity cushion thin at ~8–10%. S&P/MS calling it a "template transaction" — expect MSFT/AMZN/GOOG copies.

— *Global Data Center Hub*, 2026, globaldatacenterhub.com/p/meta-blue-owls-27b-bet-is-this-the

- **Data-center ABS spreads tightened ~60 bp** over two weeks into early-May. CloudHQ 5-yr AAA priced +125 bp / 5.1% (Apr 20); single-A 5-yr +175 bp / 5.6%. JPMorgan projects \$30–40B/yr of data-center securitization in 2026–27 (7–10% of combined CMBS+ABS). Switch filed a deed of trust enabling up to \$15B of ABS advances.

— *Green Street*, 2026-05, greenstreetnews.com/article/data-center-abs-spreads-race-back-in/; S&P Global, 2026-02, spglobal.com/market-intelligence/en/news-insights/research/2026/02/banks-meeting-data-center-demand-with-billions-in-credit-facilities-bonds

Utility / IG debt

- **FPL (NextEra) sold \$2.25B First Mortgage Bonds in 3 tranches June 1.** Single-A utility paper yielding ~5.05–5.20%; Southern still trades 5–10 bp wide of the single-A average. Broad HY technicals supportive: ~\$27B new issuance, books ~3.5x covered, NIC ~1.7 bp.

— *minichart*, 2026-06, minichart.com.sg/2026/06/02/nextera-energy-files-8-k-for-new-corporate-units-offerings-and-legal-opinions-june-2026/

Infrastructure megafunds / private credit

- **Brookfield Global Transition Fund II final close \$20B** (largest-ever transition fund; ~\$23.5B with co-invest). **KKR infra Fund V at \$12.5B** on a record year; **Stonepeak Opportunities II** tracking to beat its \$3.5B target in 1H26. Private-credit origination for data centers concentrated in Blackstone, Blue Owl, Apollo, PIMCO, BlackRock.

— *Infrastructure Investor*, 2026, infrastructureinvestor.com/brookfield-surpasses-target-to-close-bgtf-ii-on-20bn/

Space Economy → Domestic Land / Resource / Energy

Texas land footprint

- **Starbase, TX annexing 7,133 acres** in Cameron County — growing the incorporated city ~9x (from ~927 to ~8,060 acres); advanced in a Feb 18 closed session. Separately, a federal land swap gives SpaceX **715 acres of the Lower Rio Grande Valley NWR** near Boca Chica for 683 acres of private land (approved early June) — among the largest refuge exchanges outside Alaska, now drawing a federal lawsuit from environmental/tribal groups.

— *RGV Business Journal*, 2026-06; *FWS*, fws.gov/project/potential-land-exchange-spacex

- **Spaceport power as a bottleneck**: upgrading Cape Canaveral's electrical system is pegged at ~\$275M, deemed insufficient for certain launch ops (one of six infrastructure constraints). No hard public data yet on a dedicated Starbase TX power source — a PUCT filing would confirm.

— *CBS Miami / Space Florida*, 2026, cbsnews.com/miami/news/6-projects-eyed-to-increase-florida-space-launches/

Datacenter-in-space — the land/grid displacement thesis

- **SpaceX filed with the FCC Jan 30 for an orbital data-center constellation of up to 1 million satellites**, framing ~1M tonnes/yr of launches as ~100 GW of orbital AI compute — equivalent to ~20% of current US electricity that would otherwise sit on US land/grid (filed 3 days before the SpaceX/xAI merger closed Feb 2).

— *SpaceNews*, 2026-01, spacenews.com/spacex-files-plans-for-million-satellite-orbital-data-center-constellation/

- **Starcloud (Nvidia Inception) raised a \$170M Series A at a \$1.1B valuation**. CEO is explicit the economics don't work "until Starship is flying frequently" at ~\$500/kg. Scale anchor: entire Starlink network (~10,000 sats) ≈ 200 MW vs 25+ GW of US terrestrial data centers under construction.

— *TechCrunch*, 2026-03-30, techcrunch.com/2026/03/30/starcloud-raises-170-million-series-ato-build-data-centers-in-space/

Space-based solar power

- **Meta signed its first capacity reservation (up to 1 GW) with Overview Energy** for a 1,000-satellite GEO fleet (first transmission test Jan 2028, commercial 2030) — an AI-power-sourcing play ("not clear if any money changed hands"). Aetherflux (Baiju Bhatt) raised a \$50M Series A for laser power-beaming to ground PV, first demo 2026; domestic angle is receivers at remote/military sites.

— *TechCrunch*, 2026-04-27, techcrunch.com/2026/04/27/meta-inks-deal-for-solar-power-at-night-beamed-from-space/

Lunar resources & defense

- **Interlune signed a lunar helium-3 offtake with Bluefors valued at up to \$300M** (He-3 demand driven by quantum-computer cooling and fusion). Initial mission costs cited at \$50–100B with long payback — VC structures don't fit yet. **Golden Dome** drew ~\$23–25B in FY26 reconciliation (20-yr estimate to \$1.2T), with \$1.7B SDA LEO sats, \$1.4B Next-Gen OPIR, plus ground radars and launch infrastructure — but no single line item, limiting oversight.

— *Discovery Alert*, 2026; *Federal News Network*, 2026-01, federalnewsnetwork.com/congress/2026/01/golden-dome-got-23-billion-but-lawmakers-still-dont-know-how-it-will-be-spent/

Confidence notes

- A handful of figures rest on search-index extraction rather than full-text fetch (publisher 403s): the Nvidia \$25B/\$85B book and data-center ABS spreads; the Meta/Blue Owl +225 bp spread and 16-yr RVG (cross-consistent but worth an offering-memo check); the SpaceX 715/683-acre refuge swap (cross-confirmed via FWS). Per-acre comps on smaller PE Midland deals and a clean behind-the-meter Permian gas PPA \$/MW did not surface in public sources.
- Vistra and NuScale/Oklo Q1 earnings-call transcripts did not surface cleanly; their items here come from filings and secondary coverage.